

Exercise 15 - Changing the Connotation

Original Text (Neutral):

"Maria moved to a new neighborhood last month. Her house is small, but it's close to her job. She doesn't know many people yet, and she spends most of her time at home. Every morning, she walks to the bus stop and goes to work. Her days are quiet and simple."

Rewrite it with a positive connotation.

Maria settled into a charming new neighborhood last month. Her home is cozy and compact, plus it's conveniently located near her workplace. She's gradually meeting new friends, and she cherishes her peaceful time at home. Each morning, she enjoys a refreshing walk to the bus stop before heading to work. Her days are serene and fulfilling.

Rewrite it with a negative connotation.

Maria was relocated to an unfamiliar neighborhood last month. Her house is cramped and tiny, even though it's trapped near her job. She hasn't connected with anyone, and she wastes most days isolated at home. Every morning, she makes a tedious trek to the bus stop just to get to work. Her days are dull and uneventful.

In the POSITIVE version:

- Settled into → sounds more voluntary and comfortable
- Cozy and compact → makes small spaces seem welcoming
- Conveniently located → highlights the advantage of the location
- Gradually meeting new friends → sounds hopeful
- cherishes → shows appreciation for time at home
- Enjoys a refreshing walk → makes walking sound pleasant
- Serene and fulfilling → makes tranquility seem valuable

In the NEGATIVE version:

- Was relocated to → sounds forced and impersonal
- Cramped and tiny → emphasizes how uncomfortable the small space is
- Trapped near → makes the proximity seem like a trap
- hasn't connected with anyone → highlights the loneliness
- Wastes most days isolated → makes time at home seem wasted
- Makes a tedious trek → turns the walk into something boring and tedious
- Dull and uneventful → makes tranquility seem like boredom